

Vocabulary Development: Religion

Meaning of Religion

Religion is the belief in and worship of a supreme being (God or gods). It also involves practices, moral values, and ways of life followed by believers.

1. Words Associated with Christianity

Word

Meaning

Bible

The holy book of Christians

Church

A place of worship for Christians

Pastor

A leader in a church

Prayer

Talking to God

Gospel

The good news about Jesus Christ

Baptism

A religious rite using water

Communion

Sharing bread and wine in remembrance of Jesus

Salvation

Being saved from sin

Hymn

A religious song

Disciple

A follower of Jesus Christ

2. Words Associated with Islam

Word

Meaning

Qur'an

The holy book of Muslims

Mosque

A place of worship for Muslims

Imam

A leader of prayers in Islam

Salah (Salat)

The act of prayer in Islam

Zakat

Giving to the poor (charity)

Sawm

Fasting during Ramadan

Hajj

Pilgrimage to Mecca

Allah

The name of God in Islam

Hadith

Sayings of Prophet Muhammad

Ummah

The Muslim community

3. Words Associated with Traditional Religion

Word

Meaning

Shrine

A sacred place of worship

Deity

A god or spirit

Ancestors

Family members who lived long ago and are honored

Sacrifice

Offering made to gods or spirits

Priest/Priestess

A religious leader

Oracle

A place or person through whom gods speak

Ritual

A set of religious actions

Libation

Pouring liquid as an offering

Totem

A symbol of a family or group

Festival

A religious celebration

Importance of Learning Religious Vocabulary

Helps in understanding different religions and cultures

Improves communication and comprehension

Promotes tolerance and respect among people

Builds vocabulary for exams and writing

Exercise

Define the following:

a. Zakat

b. Baptism

c. Ancestors

Use any five words from the list in sentences.

Match the words with the correct religion.

1. More Words Associated with Christianity

Word

Meaning

Trinity

God as Father, Son, and Holy Spirit

Crucifixion

The death of Jesus on the cross

Resurrection

Jesus rising from the dead

Apostle

A special messenger of Jesus

Parable

A short story used to teach lessons

Grace

God's free gift of love and mercy

Faith

Strong belief and trust in God

Sin

Wrongdoing against God

Forgiveness

Letting go of wrong done

Heaven

The home of God

Hell

A place of punishment

Angel

A messenger of God

Commandments

Laws given by God

Worship

Showing reverence to God

Offering

A gift given in church

2. More Words Associated with Islam

Word

Meaning

Ramadan

The month of fasting

Eid al-Fitr

Festival marking the end of Ramadan

Eid al-Adha

Festival of sacrifice

Sunnah

Practices of Prophet Muhammad

Sharia

Islamic law

Halal

What is permitted in Islam

Haram

What is forbidden

Dua

Personal prayer

Wudu

Washing before prayer

Kaaba

Sacred building in Mecca

Jannah

Paradise

Jahannam

Hell

Iman

Faith in Islam

Tawhid

Belief in one God

Adhan

Call to prayer

3. More Words Associated with Traditional Religion

Word

Meaning

Divination

Seeking knowledge from spirits

Medium

A person who communicates with spirits

Incantation

Words spoken with magical power

Charm

Object believed to have power

Talisman

Object for protection

Masquerade

Cultural/religious masked figure

Initiation

Ceremony of entering adulthood or group

Totemism

Belief in symbols or sacred animals

Spirit

Invisible supernatural being

Clan

A group of related families

Sacred

Holy or special

Taboo

Forbidden act

Myth

Traditional story explaining beliefs

Healing

Spiritual or traditional treatment

Festival rites

Ceremonies during festivals

Class Activity

Group the words under the correct religion

Use at least 10 words in sentences

Compare similar terms (e.g., Prayer – Salah – Ritual)